

Διόδωρος ὁ Σικελιώτης

Diodorus of Sicily and His Universal History

eul_aid: nde

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)

Dialect: Κοινή [Koine](#)

Domain: Ἱστορία [History](#)

Format: Πεζός [Prose](#)

Diodorus Siculus was a Greek historian from Agyrium in Sicily who flourished in the 1st century BCE during the time of Julius Caesar and Augustus. He traveled extensively in Asia and Europe and resided in Rome to research his universal history, where he accessed written sources and learned Latin. His life is known almost exclusively from his own writings.

His sole surviving work is the Bibliotheca historica, a 40-book universal history spanning from mythological times to 60/59 BCE. Only Books 1–5 and 11–20 survive intact, with fragments remaining of the others. Diodorus is significant as the compiler of one of the few surviving universal histories from antiquity.

His work is an indispensable, if not always critically rigorous, source for Sicilian, Greek, and Hellenistic history, preserving valuable fragments from lost historians like Ephorus and Hieronymus of Cardia. Intended for moral instruction, his history remains a crucial narrative for periods where other sources are lacking.

Works (3)

- Ἀποσπάσματα Ἀδήλου Θέσεως · [Fragments of Uncertain Placement](#) · 13 passages
- Βιβλιοθήκη Ἱστορική · [Historical Library, Books 18-20](#) · 7424 passages
- Βιβλιοθήκη Ἱστορική · [Historical Library, Books 21-40](#) · 852 passages